County Council Meeting
Beaufort County, SC

Council Chambers, Administration Building
Beaufort County Government Robert Smalls Complex
100 Ribaut Road, Beaufort

Monday, May 11, 2026
6:00 PM

MINUTES

Watch the video stream available on the County's website to hear the Council's discussion of a specific topic or the complete meeting **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/387301**

1. Call to Order

Vice-Chair Tabernik called the meeting to order at 6:20 PM

Present
Chair Alice Howard - Virtual
Vice-Chair Anna Maria Tabernik
Council Member David Bartholomew
Council Member Paula Brown
Council Member Logan Cunningham
Council Member Gerald Dawson
Council Member York Glover
Council Member Mark Lawson
Council Member Lawrence McElynn
Council Member Joseph Passiment
Council Member Thomas Reitz

2. Pledge of Allegiance and Invocation

Council Member Lawson led the Pledge of Allegiance and gave the invocation.

3. Statement of Compliance with FOIA

Vice-Chair Tabernik stated that public notification of this meeting had been published, posted, and distributed in compliance with SC FOIA.

4. Approval of Agenda

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Dawson to approve the agenda.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

5. Approval of Minutes

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Brown to approve the minutes from County Council Budget Workshop on April 20, 2026, Caucus and County Council Meeting on April 27, 2026.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

6. Proclamations

a. Proclamation recognizing May 6–12 as National Nurses Week.

Council Member Brown presented a proclamation recognizing May 6–12 as National Nurses Week to nurses and staff from Beaufort Memorial Hospital.

b. Proclamation recognizing May 10-16 as National Hospital Week.

Council Member Passiment presented a proclamation recognizing May 10-16 as National Hospital Week to nurses and staff from Beaufort Memorial Hospital

c. Proclamation recognizing May 3-9 as National Correction Officers Week.

Council Member McElynn presented a proclamation recognizing May 3-9 as National Correction Officers week to representatives from the Beaufort County Detention Center.

d. Proclamation recognizing May 17-23 as Emergency Medical Services Week.

Council Member Dawson presented a proclamation recognizing May 17-23 as Emergency Medical Services Week to representatives from Beaufort County EMS.

e. Proclamation recognizing May as International Doula Month.

Council Member Glover presented a proclamation recognizing May as International Doula Month to representatives from Energy Evolution.

7. Administrator's Report

Administrator Moore updated Council on the Transportation Advisory Committee. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report.
https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/387301

8. Public Comment Period

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to extend public comment.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full public comment.
https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/387301

9. Liaison and Committee Reports

Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report.
https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/387301

10. Presentations and Discussion Items

a. Presentation of Sales Tax Recommendations by the Transportation Advisory Committee

Committee Chair Lisa Sulka presented the Transportation Advisory Committee Memo to Council. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full presentation. **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/387301**

11. Agenda Item

a. Consideration of the Real Property Covenant and Land Use Restrictions provided by the Town of Bluffton for their Green Space Program application (Buckwalter PUD Tracts – Parcels 5A & 5B), located in the Town of Bluffton

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Brown, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to authorize the County Administrator to make the grant on parcels 5A and 5B as a reimbursable grant by giving him authority to negotiate on a couple of the points of acreage impact and on the prospect of a potential road known as 5B.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

12. Ordinances for Third Reading

a. 2026/10: An Ordinance to reallocate remaining American Rescue Plan Act (ARPA) funds in the amount of $739,108.13 towards existing projects as obligated to the Department of Treasury.

The vote at Finance, Administration, and Economic Development Committee on March 16, 2026 - 8:0
The vote at First Reading on April 13, 2026 - 11:0
The vote at Second Reading and Public Hearing on April 27, 2026 - 10:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Lawson, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve Third Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/10.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

b. 2026/11: An Ordinance Authorizing the County Administrator to Execute the necessary documents and provide funding for the purchase of real property located at 641 Sea Island Parkway.

The vote at Finance, Administration, and Economic Development Committee on March 16, 2026 - 8:0
The vote at First Reading on April 13, 2026 - 11:0
The vote at Second Reading and Public Hearing on April 27, 2026 - 10:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Glover, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve Third Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/11.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

c. 2026/12: An Ordinance authorizing the County Administrator to execute the necessary documents to convey five parcels of real property TMS Nos. R120 005 000 0105 0000, R120 005 000 0127 0000, R120 005 000 0132 0000, R120 005 000 132A 0000, R120 005 000 0133 0000, to the Beaufort Jasper Housing Trust for development of attainable housing in partnership with Beaufort Memorial Hospital and other matters related thereto.

The vote at Public Facilities Committee on March 16, 2026 - 7:0
The vote at First Reading on April 13, 2026 - 11:0
The vote at Second Reading and Public Hearing on April 27, 2026 - 10:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve Third Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/12.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

d. 2026/13: An Ordinance to amend Beaufort County's Ordinance Chapter 38 Environment, Article VII Green Space Program, Section 38-196 Method of Program and Procedures of the Beaufort County Code of Ordinances.

The vote at Natural Resources Committee on April 06, 2026 - 7:0
The vote at First Reading on April 13, 2026 - 11:0
The vote at Second Reading and Public Hearing on April 27, 2026 - 10:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve Third Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/13.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

e. 2026/14: An Ordinance adding a new Section 54-8 to the Beaufort County Code of Ordinances so as to prohibit and make unlawful the discharge of firearms in certain unincorporated areas of the county, to provide the civil penalty pertaining to such violations, and to provide certain exceptions and limitations thereto.

The vote at Community Services and Public Safety Committee on April 6, 2026 - 9:0
The vote at First Reading on April 13, 2026 - 11:0
The vote at Second Reading and Public Hearing on April 27, 2026 - 10:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Brown, seconded by Council Member Passiment to approve Third Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/14.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

f. 2026/16: An Ordinance authorizing the County Administrator to execute the necessary documents to convey a parcel of real property TMS No. R100 033 00A 021B 000 to the Habitat for Humanity of the Lowcountry for development of workforce/affordable housing and other matters related thereto.

The vote at Community Services and Public Safety Committee on March 2, 2026 - 7:0

The vote at First Reading on April 13, 2026 - 11:0
The vote at Second Reading and Public Hearing on April 27, 2026 - 10:0

Motion: It was moved by Chair Howard, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve Third Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/16.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

13. Ordinances for Second Reading

a. 2026/17: An Ordinance to amend Beaufort County's Budget Ordinance for Fiscal Year 2026 (ordinance no. 2025/29) to appropriate General Fund Fund Balance for the purpose of purchasing a helicopter for BCSO; redemption of certain General Obligation Bonds; and fully fund the Buckwalter Recreation Athletic Complex Expansion project.

The vote at Finance, Administration, and Economic Development Committee on April 20, 2026 - 9:0
The vote at First Reading on April 27, 2026 - 8:2

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Council Member Brown to approve Second Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/17.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz.

Voting Nay: Council Member Glover. The motion passed 10:1.

b. 2026/18: An Ordinance Authorizing the Purchase of Real Property from the Town of Hilton Head Island for the St. James Baptist Church Relocation Project.

The vote at Public Facilities Committee on April 20, 2026 - 10:0
The vote at First Reading on April 27, 2026 - 10:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Reitz, seconded by Council Member Passiment to approve Second Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/18.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

c. 2026/19: An Ordinance Authorizing the Conveyance of Real Property to St. James Baptist Church Following Completion of the Relocation Project.

The vote at Public Facilities Committee on April 20, 2026 - 10:0
The vote at First Reading on April 27, 2026 - 10:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Reitz, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve Second Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/19.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover,

Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

d. 2026/22: An Ordinance to amend the current Disaster Recovery Ordinance.

The vote at Public Facilities Committee on April 20, 2026 - 10:0
The vote at First Reading on April 27, 2026 - 10:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve Second Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/22.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

e. 2026/23: An Ordinance authorizing the County Administrator to execute all necessary documents to convey the County's Right of Way Interest in a segment of Scheper Lane to SCDOT and to accept the SCDOT Right of Way Interest in a segment of Roosevelt Avenue into the County Road Inventory.

The vote at Public Facilities Committee on April 20, 2026 - 10:0
The vote at First Reading on April 27, 2026 - 10:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Lawson to approve Second Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/23.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

f. 2026/24: An Ordinance authorizing the County Administrator to execute any and all necessary documents for the acceptance of a portion of Airport Circle (S-776) which is to be abandoned by SCDOT.

The vote at Public Facilities Committee on April 20, 2026 - 10:0
The vote at First Reading on April 27, 2026 - 10:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve Second Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/24.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

g. 2026/25: An Ordinance authorizing the conveyance of an undeveloped portion of real property adjacent to Nanny Cove Road located in a section of Palmetto Beach in Bluffton Township, Beaufort County.

The vote at Public Facilities Committee on April 20, 2026 - 10:0
The vote at First Reading on April 27, 2026 - 10:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Lawson, seconded by Council Member Brown to approve Second Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/25.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

14. Ordinances for First Reading

a. 2026/26: An Ordinance amending Chapter 38 Environment, Article VI Single Use Plastic Bags; Article VI Section 38-161 Purpose and Intent; Section 38-162 Definitions; Section 38-163 Regulations; Section 38-164 Exemptions; and Section 38-166 Effective Date and Review of the Beaufort County Code of Ordinances.

The vote at Natural Resources Committee on April 6, 2026 - 5:2

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Dawson to approve First Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/26.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member McElynn, and Council Member Passiment.

Voting Nay: Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 6:5.

15. Adjournment

COUNTY COUNCIL OF BEAUFORT COUNTY

Alice G. Howard

BY: _____
Alice G. Howard, Chairman

ATTEST:

Sarah W. Brock

_____
Sarah W. Brock, Clerk to Council
Ratified: May 27, 2026